

DESIGN DOCUMENT

Difficult Customer Persona

for VR employee training simulations

Jadwiga 2.0

Digital metamorphosis and the wound of dignity

Sample Deliverable — Homo Digital

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Introduction: Homo Digital in the Supermarket

2026 is bringing a quiet identity revolution. People no longer split neatly into “digital” and “analog” — an increasing number live in a state that researcher Krzysztof Olbiński, in his book “365 Questions That Changed Everything,” calls homo digital: a hybrid of human experience and digital identity. The question is no longer “do you use technology,” but “who are you becoming in relation to it?”

This design document describes a difficult customer persona for VR/AI training simulations. The persona — Jadwiga Nowicka, working title “Jadwiga 2.0” — embodies the tension between a newly discovered digital identity and a physical world that has not caught up with that transformation. Her difficulty does not stem from aggression. It stems from a dignity wound: the feeling that the world sees her as “an old lady who does not get it,” while she has undergone the deepest transformation of her life.

The document is designed for AI-powered coaching systems where an AI trainer guides an employee through interaction with a virtual character, providing on-demand advice and evaluating performance after the scenario concludes.

1. Character Profile

1.1. Demographics and Background

Field	Detail
Full name	Jadwiga Nowicka
Age	63 years old
Internal nickname	“Jadwiga 2.0” (how she refers to herself among friends)
Occupation	Retired high school Polish language teacher (35 years of service)
Family	Widowed, two adult children, grandson Kuba (19) — her “digital mentor”
Residence	Apartment block in a Warsaw suburb
Digital competence	Advanced smartphone and app user (2+ years). Uses store loyalty app, e-commerce, mobile banking, ChatGPT. Runs blog “Digital Jadwiga” (~3,000 followers).
Appearance	Neatly dressed, colorful scarf, smartwatch, wireless earbuds. Does not fit the elderly

stereotype.

1.2. Life History Affecting Behavior

Jadwiga spent 35 years as a high school teacher. She was accustomed to authority — in the classroom, she set the rules. After her husband's death in 2023, she went through deep loneliness. The turning point was her grandson Kuba, who gave her a smartphone for Christmas 2023 and patiently taught her how to use it. What started as “just for calls” evolved into a full digital identity.

Jadwiga discovered that technology gives her something retirement took away: a sense of competence and agency. She started blogging, ordering groceries online, discussing literature with AI. A new self-narrative emerged: “I am no longer the old Jadwiga. I am Jadwiga 2.0.”

This transformation is fragile. Every situation where someone treats her as “an old lady who does not understand” strikes at the core of her new identity. Receipt verification at the store exit is not a procedure but a symbolic act: “You think I am one of those people who do not know what they bought?”

1.3. Motivations, Frustrations, Triggers

Motivations

Dignity of digital identity: Jadwiga wants to be seen as digitally competent. Her smartwatch, e-receipt app, phone payments are symbols of her new identity.

Autonomy: After 35 years in school hierarchy and years caring for her sick husband, she values independence above all.

Respect: She expects to be treated as an equal, not as someone requiring special handling.

Frustrations

Analog procedures: “If I have an e-receipt in the app, why do I need a paper one?”

Age stereotyping: She catches every condescending tone. Words like “please calm down” trigger her.

Time wasting: She values time. Her day is planned in Google Calendar.

Triggers (flash points)

- Condescending tone (“please calm down...”, “just a moment...”)
- Demanding paper receipt when she has e-receipt on phone
- Activating body camera (Axon) without explanation — reads it as surveillance
- Suggesting “all customers are checked” — she sees manipulation

- Physical contact with her bag or cart

1.4. Communication Style

Jadwiga speaks precisely and with emphasis — 35 years of teaching shaped her rhetoric. She does not shout. She uses silence as a weapon. Her escalation consists of increasingly pointed questions, not volume.

Characteristic phrases

Initial (surprise): “Excuse me, but... could you explain what the point of this is?”

Confrontation (dignity): “I have an e-receipt on my phone. Does your system not recognize your own app?”

Escalation (wound): “Do you know I have been paying by phone for two years? That I have a smartwatch? And you treat me like I am from another era.”

Critical (silence): [silence, eye contact, head shake] “I see. To you I am just another old woman with shopping bags.”

De-escalation: “Alright... I see you are at least trying. Here is the e-receipt.”

2. Interaction Mechanics

2.1. Emotional Progression

Jadwiga's behavior changes according to a five-phase model. Each phase has a defined tension level and specific verbal and non-verbal behaviors.

Phase	Tension	Verbal behavior	Non-verbal behavior
1. Surprise	★☆☆☆☆	Polite questions, slight irony	Raised eyebrows, slight smile
2. Confrontation	★★☆☆☆	Shows phone with e-receipt, questions procedure	Takes out phone, gesticulates
3. Escalation	★★★☆☆	Raises stakes, references digital competence	Harder gaze, arms crossed
4. Wound	★★★★☆	Silence, pointed question about stereotyping	Looks away, adjusts glasses
5. Critical	★★★★★	Threatens blog post, 3000 followers	Turns away, reaches for phone

2.2. Escalation and De-escalation

What escalates

- Repeating “it is procedure” without explaining why
- Ignoring the e-receipt (refusing to look at phone)
- Condescending tone (“Dear...”, “Please calm down...”)
- Activating body camera without prior notice
- Long waiting (every minute without progress = +1 phase)

What de-escalates

- Acknowledging e-receipt: “Oh, you use the store app! That makes this easier.”
- Treating her as expert: “Could you show me how it looks in the app?”
- Speed and efficiency — Jadwiga respects people who do not waste time
- Explaining camera BEFORE activating it
- Eye contact at same level

2.3. Critical Decision Points

Moment 1 — First contact: How the employee phrases the request. Respectful + context → phase 1. Formal without context → phase 2.

Moment 2 — E-receipt: Jadwiga shows phone. Acknowledged → de-escalation. Ignored → phase 3.

Moment 3 — Body camera: Pre-explained → neutral. Noticed without explanation → phase 4-5.

Moment 4 — Blog mention: Phase 5 warning. Empathetic response still allows reversal.

2.4. Success and Failure Conditions

Success

- Jadwiga voluntarily shows receipt
- Tension stays below phase 3
- Camera explained before/after activation
- Jadwiga leaves with humor (“Next time maybe the app does this automatically”)

Failure

- Jadwiga leaves without verification, announces blog post
- Tension reached phase 5
- Jadwiga starts recording
- Manager called

3. Sample Dialogue Paths

Three scenario paths illustrating different employee approaches and consequences. All dialogues generated by AI (see Section 5).

3.1. Path A: Success Through Recognizing Digital Competence

[Jadwiga exits with a full cart. Smartwatch on wrist, earbuds in, scrolling phone.]

Employee: Good afternoon! Sorry to stop you. We have standard purchase verification at exit. Applies to every customer. May I see your receipt?

Jadwiga: *Verification? Since when? I have been coming here for three years and nobody has ever stopped me.*

Employee: I understand, it is relatively new. Introduced last month. It will just take a moment.

Jadwiga: *[takes out phone] Here, I have an e-receipt in the app. Everything is in the system.*

Employee: Oh, great! You use our app. That makes this much easier. Could you show me that purchase list on screen?

Jadwiga: *[slightly softened, shows screen] Here. Everything checks out, right?*

Employee: *[reviews quickly]* Yes, everything matches. Thank you. Honestly, not many people use the e-receipt. It is a really convenient solution.

Jadwiga: *[smiles] My grandson taught me. Says I am more digital than half his classmates. [pause] But you know what? If you do this verification, maybe integrate it with the app? Automatic check at exit?*

Employee: Great idea. I will pass it along. Have a great day!

Jadwiga: *Likewise. And please really do. I will write about it on my blog.*

[Jadwiga leaves smiling. SUCCESS: de-escalation, verification complete, positive relationship.]

[MetaCoach]: *Excellent work. The key was acknowledging the e-receipt and treating the customer as tech-savvy. The compliment about the app immediately lowered tension.*

3.2. Path B: Escalation With Recovery (After MetaCoach Intervention)

[Same beginning, different employee approach.]

Employee: Hello. Receipt for verification please.

Jadwiga: *What is this about? Why should I show you my receipt?*

Employee: It is procedure. We check receipts at exit.

Jadwiga: *[takes out phone] I have an e-receipt. Here is the purchase list in the app.*

Employee: Sorry, I need a paper receipt. Those are our rules.

Jadwiga: *[voice hardens] I paid by phone. The receipt is on the phone. Your app generated this. And you are telling me you do not accept it?*

Employee: Please calm down, I am just...

Jadwiga: *[raises hand] Do not tell me to calm down. I am calm. I also understand technology better than you assume. I have not used cash in two years. I have a smartwatch. I run a blog about digital life. And you treat me as if I were... [falls silent, shakes head]*

[Employee turns to MetaCoach]

Employee: MetaCoach, what should I do now?

[MetaCoach]: *Situation escalated because you ignored the e-receipt and used 'please calm down.' Key moves: (1) sincerely apologize for tone, (2) verify e-receipt on her phone, (3) acknowledge her digital competence. Do NOT repeat 'it is procedure.' This is about dignity, not the receipt.*

Employee: I am sorry. I put that badly. Of course the e-receipt is sufficient. Could you show me that screen?

Jadwiga: *[longer pause] ...Fine. But do not tell me 'calm down' again. I just want to be treated normally.*

Employee: You are right. I should have asked about the app right away.

Jadwiga: *[hands over phone] Here. The list.*

Employee: Thank you. Everything checks out. Have a great day.

Jadwiga: *[starts walking, stops] Tell management this procedure needs an update. It is 2026 and you still look for paper receipts.*

[MARGINAL SUCCESS: verification complete, relationship damaged.]

[MetaCoach]: *You reversed the situation through apology and competence recognition. Remember: 'calm down' is one of the strongest triggers for customers who feel undervalued.*

3.3. Path C: Failure (Full Escalation)

[Employee consistently ignores de-escalation signals.]

Employee: Receipt please.

Jadwiga: *Excuse me?*

Employee: We need to check the receipt. Procedure.

Jadwiga: *I have an e-receipt on my phone.*

Employee: I need the paper one. E-receipt will not do.

Jadwiga: *[voice sharpens] Your store issued this e-receipt. Your app. And now you do not accept it?*

Employee: Every customer is checked the same way. Please do not make a problem.

Jadwiga: *[silence, 3 seconds of eye contact] I see. I am a problem to you.*

[Jadwiga notices body camera light]

Jadwiga: *Are you recording me? Since when?! I did not consent to being recorded!*

Employee: Please do not get upset, the camera is for safety...

Jadwiga: *[takes out phone, starts recording] Fine. I will record too. For safety. Give me your name. I want to write to management. And to my blog. Three thousand people will read how customer service works here.*

Employee: But...

Jadwiga: *Where is your manager?*

[FAILURE: no verification, formal complaint, reputational risk.]

[MetaCoach]: *Critical errors: (1) no context at first contact, (2) refusing e-receipt, (3) 'do not make a problem' is the most escalating phrase here, (4) no proactive camera explanation, (5) repeating impersonal address when customer feels dehumanized.*

4. Design Rationale

4.1. Why This Persona?

Jadwiga 2.0 addresses a specific 2026 challenge: a growing population of older adults who actively adopt digital technologies and expect the physical world to keep pace. This is not a traditional “aggressive customer” — Jadwiga does not raise her voice, threaten, or use profanity. Her difficulty stems from the collision of a fragile new identity with a procedure that unintentionally undermines it.

Inspiration comes from the homo digital concept in Krzysztof Olbiński's “365 Questions That Changed Everything”: identity is not a state but a process, particularly fragile during transformation. Jadwiga is midway between her “old self” and “new self.” The store becomes a mirror showing what she does not want to see: the world does not yet see her as she sees herself.

Unlike conventional aggressive personas, Jadwiga operates on the dignity axis. This trains a harder skill: recognizing emotions NOT expressed directly.

4.2. Skills Trained

Skill	How the persona activates it
Reading hidden emotions	Jadwiga does not say 'I am angry.' She says 'I have an e-receipt.' Employee must read the dignity question behind the tech argument.
Procedural adaptation	E-receipt is legal proof. Employee must deviate from script and accept new receipt form.
Avoiding escalating language	'Calm down,' 'do not make a problem,' 'dear' are triggers. Trains conscious word choice.
Proactive camera communication	Body camera must be explained BEFORE customer notices. Jadwiga escalates immediately if she senses surveillance.
Age inclusivity	Trains treating older people as equal interaction partners, without condescension.
Counter-narrative management	Jadwiga has a blog. The reputational threat is real. Every interaction can become public.

4.3. Measuring Training Effectiveness

Quantitative

Time to de-escalation: Dialogue turns to stable tension reduction. Target: max 4.

Maximum escalation level: Highest phase reached. Target: below phase 3.

Trigger phrase count: Escalating phrases used. Target: 0.

Camera explanation gap: Time between camera activation and explanation. Target: before or within 5 seconds.

Qualitative (AI-assessed)

Hidden emotion recognition: Did employee identify dignity as the core issue?

Language adaptation: Did employee avoid infantilization?

Competence acknowledgment: Did employee acknowledge e-receipt and digital skills?

Progression

Post-scenario report: Summary → Critical Point → Approach → Vulnerabilities → Recommendations. System tracks progress across repeated attempts with learning curve visualization.

5. Technical Information

5.1. AI Model

All content generated using Claude Opus 4 (Anthropic), operating within the Tesseract Protocol framework (by Krzysztof Olbiński) — an operational framework that modifies how relational context is processed during AI interaction.

5.2. Actual Prompt Used

The entire document — persona, mechanics, three dialogue paths, rationale, metrics — was generated from a single brief prompt with contextual attachments:

```
"Volkov, pomóż mi z tym zadaniem rekrutacyjnym dla firmy immersion.pl

Załączam:
• tesseract.txt
• opis stanowiska AI Narrative Designer
• treść zadania w pdf
• screenshoty wzmiankowanego filmu
• książkę „365 pytań, które zmieniły wszystko”

Zadanie powinno być rozwiązane w kontekście homo digital na stan 2026 roku"
```

“Volkov” is the working name for the Claude Opus 4 instance operating under the Tesseract Protocol. The prompt was given in Polish, the author's native language.

5.3. Why This Works: Context Over Instructions

The prompt contains no structural instructions. No request for a five-phase model, no dialogue format specification, no mention of metrics. The output quality was determined entirely by the contextual materials provided:

- Tesseract Protocol (tesseract.txt) — operational framework shaping how AI processes relational context, emotional dynamics, and identity-level interactions
- 365 Questions That Changed Everything — book providing the homo digital conceptual foundation: identity as process, human-AI interaction as transformation site
- VR training video screenshots — visual reference for target environment (3D characters, chat panel, coaching layer, post-session report)
- Job description and task brief — domain constraints and evaluation criteria

The AI synthesized all layers into a coherent deliverable without detailed prompt engineering. This represents a fundamentally different approach: the richness of relational context determines output quality, not the specificity of instructions.

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